UNIT 3 Innovation

Dictation + Text 2

Lesson 2 / 4

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课程资料：https://chezvivian.github.io/class/posts/2026-9-8-BusinessEnglish-2026/



2/4 Roadmap


01 Dictation
(10% of final grade)
02 Warming up
03 Text 2
Identifying the Unmet Needs in a Digital Age

01

Dictation

(10% of final grade)



02 Warming up



3 Read the words and phrases and their explanations. Then complete the following paragraph with the proper forms of the words and phrases.

blockchain: a secure and transparent way to record transactions across multiple computers, ensuring that once a transaction is recorded, it cannot be changed or deleted. This technology is often used for digital currencies

data analysis: the process of examining data to uncover hidden patterns, correlations, and insights, enabling better decision-making and strategic business moves

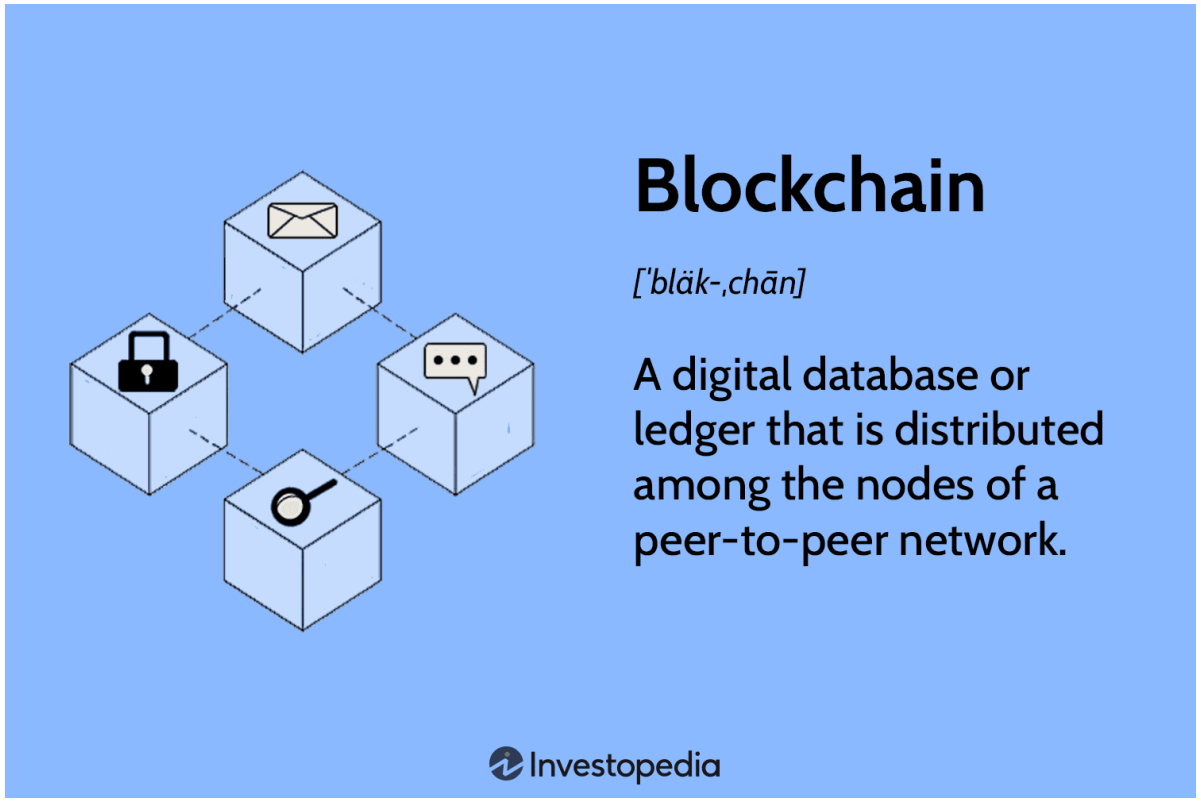
cybersecurity: the practice of protecting systems, networks, and programs from digital attacks aimed at accessing, changing, or destroying sensitive information, stealing money from users, or interrupting normal business processes

algorithmic recommendation: the use of algorithms to suggest content, products, or services based on user preferences and behavior, often used in digital platforms to enhance user experience and engagement

fintech: financial technology, referring to software, mobile applications, and other technologies designed to improve and automate traditional forms of finance for businesses and consumers



Blockchain 区块链



什么是区块链？

- 区块链本质上是一个**数字账本**（类似记录交易的笔记本），但它不是存储在一个中心位置，而是**分布式**存储在许多台计算机上。

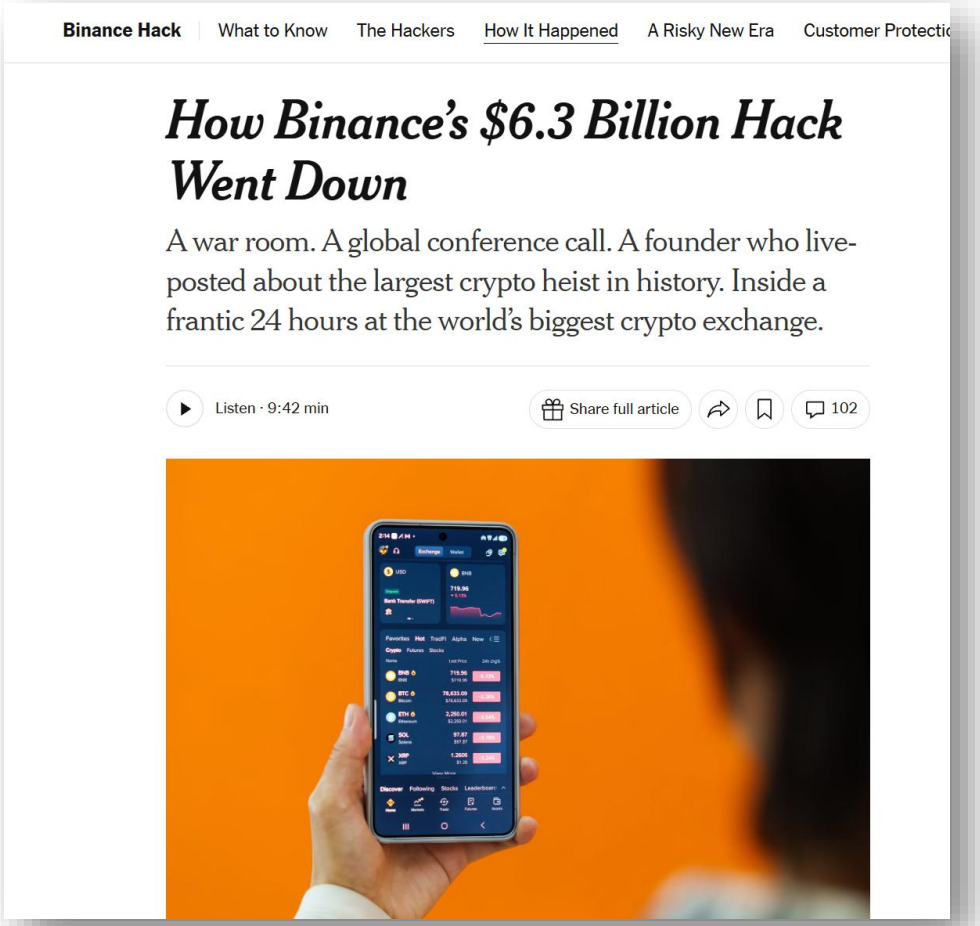
核心特征：

- **去中心化** - 没有单一的个人或组织控制它；网络由多个参与者共同管理
- **透明性** - 所有参与者都能看到交易历史，创造信任
- **不可篡改** - 一旦信息被记录在"区块"中，就无法在不被所有人发现的情况下被更改或删除
- **安全性** - 使用密码学（复杂的数学代码）来保护数据

实际应用：

- **加密货币**（比特币、以太坊）- 数字货币
- **供应链追踪** - 追踪产品从工厂到商店的全过程
- **智能合约** - 满足条件时自动执行的协议
- **医疗记录** - 医院之间安全地共享患者数据

News：币安 (Binance)63亿美元加密货币被盗



课文概念	新闻内容
fintech / crypto exchange	加密货币，Binance 币安公司
blockchain	on-chain tracking (Chainalysis, TRM)
innovation vs risk	AI 让攻击更复杂
regulation	2023 反洗钱罚款
market impact	行业连锁反应、稳定币冻结

Fintech 金融科技



什么是金融科技？

- Fintech 是 **"Financial Technology"（金融科技）的缩写 - 它指的是将技术整合到金融服务中，**使其更高效、更易获取、更用户友好。

常见的金融科技应用：

- **移动支付应用** - 支付宝、微信支付、PayPal、Venmo
  - 功能：转账、支付账单、与朋友分摊费用
- **数字银行** - 没有实体网点的纯线上银行
  - 例子：Revolut、Chime、微众银行
- **投资平台** - 让初学者也能轻松投资的应用
  - 例子：Robinhood、eToro、蚂蚁财富
- **点对点借贷** - 直接连接借款人和贷款人的平台
  - 好处：双方都能获得更好的利率
- **保险科技** - 简化的、基于应用的保险
  - 例子：Lemonade、众安保险
- **加密货币交易所** - 买卖数字货币的平台
  - 例子：Coinbase、币安

3 Read the words and phrases and their explanations. Then complete the following paragraph with the proper forms of the words and phrases.

In the fast-evolving financial sector, (1) ___fintech___ is at the forefront, offering innovative solutions that make banking and financial services more accessible and user-friendly than ever before. Based on this, (2) ___blockchain___ technology introduces unmatched security and transparency by creating tamper-proof records of transactions, revolutionizing trust in digital dealings. As businesses increasingly rely on data to drive decisions, (3) ___data analysis___ becomes crucial, turning vast volumes of information into insights and competitive advantages. However, with the digitization of assets and operations, the risk of cyber threats grows, highlighting the critical role of (4) ___cybersecurity___ in protecting information and systems. Lastly, (5) ___algorithmic recommendation___ is redefining both entertainment and learning, providing personalized experiences that enhance engagement and understanding in ways previously unimaginable.

03

Text 2

Identifying the Unmet Needs in a Digital Age



Text 2 (Para 1)

n. 原则

1 It's a basic **tenet** of entrepreneurship: Innovation is all about identifying and filling people's **unmet needs**. Searching for unmet needs involves two main approaches: improving your vision of mainstream users and challenging your vision by looking at unconventional users. A four-part framework can help.

Unmet needs 未解决的需求
Meet one's needs 解决某人的需求

- *What are the two main approaches mentioned for identifying **unmet needs**?*

1. 提升你对主流用户的认知
2. 观察非常规的用户来挑战你的认知

What does each strategy focus on?



Text 2 (Para 2-3)

The Microscope Strategy 显微镜策略

2 Zooming in on the lived experiences of mainstream users can help you discern needs not surfaced by focus groups, interviews, or questionnaires. This is a natural starting point for many innovators.

3 What digital can add. The common usage of smartphones, IoT sensors, wearable technologies, and smart home devices lets organizations capture data and in real time to a much greater degree than ever before. Unlike surveys and other traditional assessment tools, digital technologies can track actual behavioral changes in real time, thus avoiding self-reporting and retrospective biases.

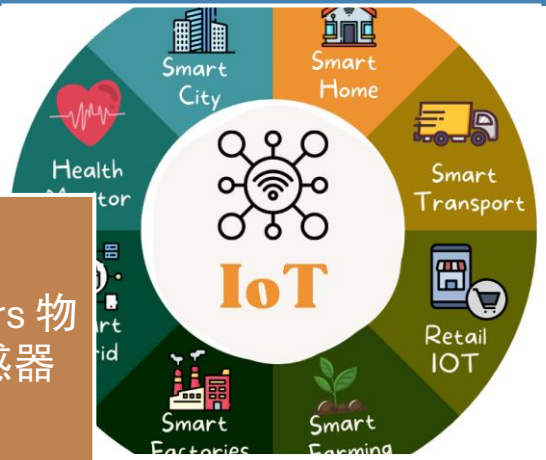
Strategy:
Zoom in on mainstream users

- **Zoom in 放大到、拉进镜头、集中**
- **Discern (v.) 辨别**
  - 近义: observe, recognize, spot
- **In real time 实时地**
- *What can digital technology add to this strategy?*

Digital technology 数字技术



Smartphones
智能手机



IoT sensors 物联网传感器



Wearable technologies
可穿戴设备



Smart home devices 智能家居设备

Text 2 (Para 4-5)

The Panorama /pænə'rɑːmə/ Strategy 全景策略

4 In addition to zooming in on individual mainstream users, you can infer their unmet needs from looking at **aggregated data**, such as errors, complaints, and accidents.

5 What digital can add. Digital tools make it much easier to observe the behavior of large numbers of individuals. Data can be collected from multiple sources and analyzed for trends. For example, smartphones can deliver digital health programs to people with chronic conditions such as diabetes and heart disease, and their sensors can feed databases that reveal overall adherence rates.

Strategy:
Looking at aggregated data

- **Aggregated data 聚合数据**
  - Aggregate (v. n. adj.) 总计的
  - In the aggregate 全部，总计

- *How can digital health programs collect user trends?*

Applications of digital health programs

How can digital health programs collect user trends?

Digital health programs 健康应用	Chronic conditions 慢性病
• **MySugr** 血糖追踪和胰岛素计算 • **Apple Heart Study** - 利用 Apple Watch 监测心律不齐 • **Noom** - 针对体重管理和慢性病预防的行为改变项目	• Diabetes 糖尿病 • Heart disease 心脏病 • Obesity 肥胖症 • High Cholesterol **高血脂** • High Blood Pressure/Hypertension 高血压

Text 2 (Para 6)

The Telescope Strategy 望远镜策略

6 If you keep looking at and interacting with the same people, in the same context, with the same tools, you risk missing **outside-the-box opportunities**. To challenge your habitual perspective, you may need to study fringe users, extreme users, or nonusers. Demands from **outliers** are often dismissed as noise. But by zooming in on common users, you might uncover pain points that are relevant to the masses, too.

Strategy:
Study **non-mainstream** users

Text 2 (Para 6)

The Telescope Strategy 望远镜策略

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- **Outside-the-box** 超越常规
- **Fringe** 边缘、非主流的、流苏
- **fringe user** 非主流用户
- **Outlier (n.)** 异类、异常值
- **Zoom in** 放大，画面拉近
- **Pain points** 痛点
- **The masses** 大众，人们

Text 2 (Para 6)

The Telescope Strategy 望远镜策略

6 …You can even learn from misusers of your offerings. **Haier** discovered that rural Chinese customers were using their washing machines to clean root vegetables, leading to clogged drainage hoses. In response, Haier developed a machine for washing both clothes and vegetables, quickly selling the first 10,000 units.

- **Misuse 不当使用**
- **Misuser 误用者**

Haier’s washing machine



Text 2 (Para 7)

The Telescope Strategy 望远镜策略

7 What digital can add. Outliers, extreme users, challenged users, misusers: Almost by definition, such populations have traditionally been hard to reach. Today, however, ***niche groups*** often gather on community sites such as Reddit and Facebook, making observing, engaging with, and learning from them much easier.

- *What can digital technology add to this strategy?*

- **Niche** /niːʃ/ (n. & adj.) 专营市场的
  - **Niche group 小众群体（相对于 mass market 大众市场）**
  - **A niche in the market 专营市场**

Niche market 小众市场





Text 2 (Para 8)

The Kaleidoscope Strategy 万花筒策略

8 To challenge your current perspective, you can also view distant players as a whole, looking for **similarities** that point to unmet needs. Think of this as similar to seeing patterns in a kaleidoscope. The difficulty, especially for entrepreneurs working within an established company, is to think beyond the usual players, such as suppliers, distributors, and competitors. For instance, **Volvo**, known for its focus on car safety, shifted attention to cyclists a decade ago after data revealed their **high casualty rates** in Sweden. This insight led to a range of innovations aimed at protecting all road users.

Strategy:
Find **similarities** from unusual groups

- **Kaleidoscope** /kəˈlaɪdəskəʊp/ 万花筒、千变万化
- **Casualty (n.) 伤亡**
  - High casualty rates 高伤亡率

Kaleidoscope 万花筒

KALEIDOSCOPIC (adj)

(kuh-lie-duh-SKOP-ik)

Definition: *Having complex patterns of colors; constantly changing.*

Examples of Kaleidoscopic in a Sentence :

*The **kaleidoscopic** nature of the markets makes them hard to predict.*



Text 2 (Para 9)

The Kaleidoscope Strategy 万花筒策略

9 What digital can add. Social-listening tools, data-scraping algorithms, and AI make it possible to quickly shift through masses of data and identify patterns therein. User-generated content often captures insights at the "moment of experience" that shed light on users' emotional states along with specific malfunctions, difficulties, or missing features in the product or service at hand.

- *What can digital technology add to this strategy?*

User-generated content provides significant insights on customer behavior patterns.

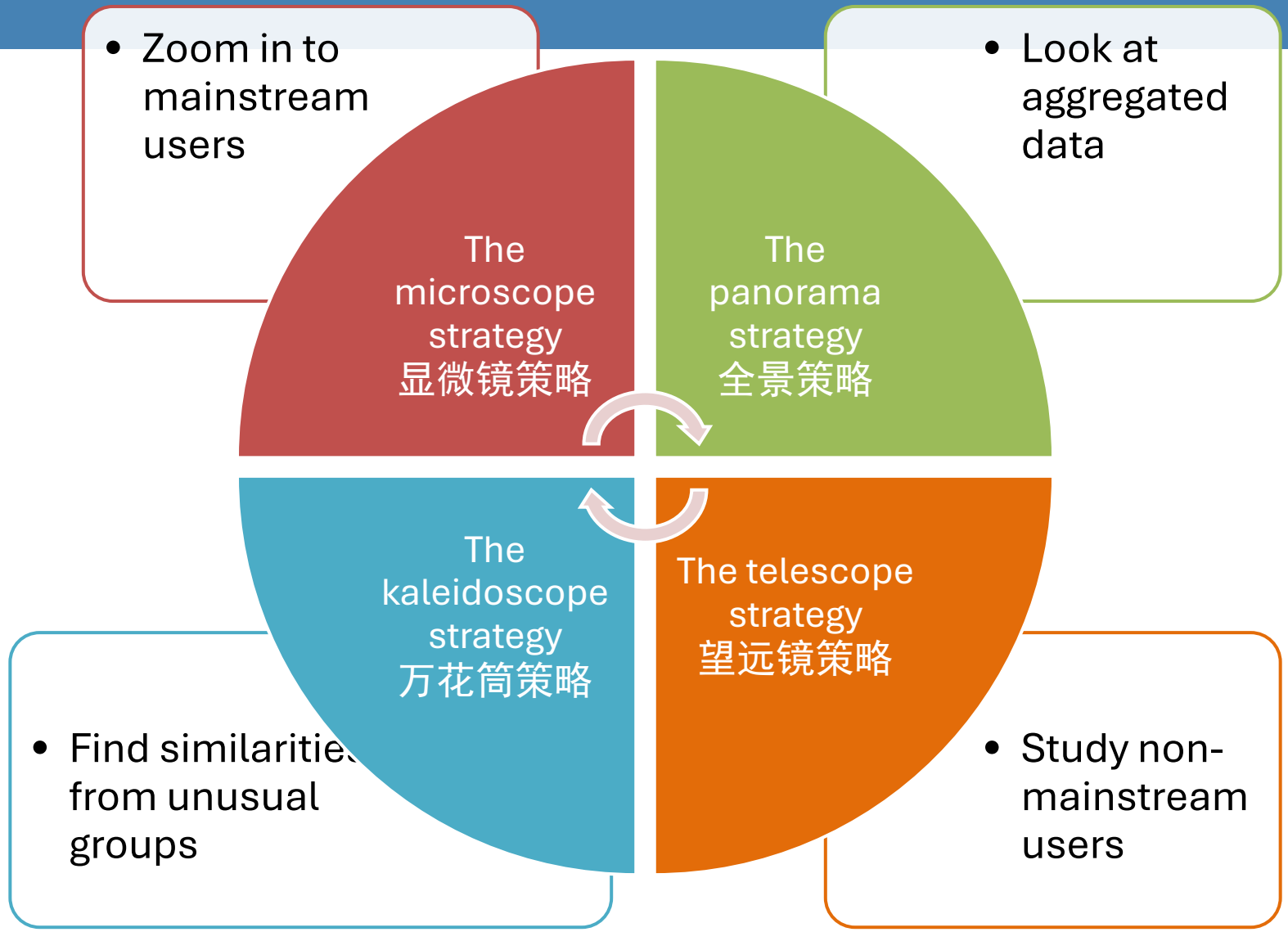
Text 2 (Para 9)

The Kaleidoscope Strategy 万花筒策略

9 What digital can add. Social-listening tools, data-scraping algorithms, and AI make it possible to quickly sift through masses of data and identify patterns **therein**. User-generated content often captures **insights** at the "moment of experience" that **shed light on** users' emotional states along with specific malfunctions, difficulties, or missing features in the product or service at hand.

- **Therein (adv.) 在那里**
  - **≈ in there**
  - **同类：thereof, thereby**
- **Insights (n.) 见解、洞察**
- **Shed light on 启发、阐明**
- **Malfunction (v. & n.) 故障**

Summary


• Zoom in to mainstream users
• Look at aggregated data
The microscope strategy 显微镜策略
The panorama strategy 全景策略
The kaleidoscope strategy 万花筒策略
The telescope strategy 望远镜策略
• Find similarities from unusual groups
• Study non-mainstream users

04

Homework



Homework

- Watch Unit 3 lead-in videos and learn Text 1 new words.

END